

Practice Handout: The Five Steps

From Justification toward Sanctification

A Practice for Living What You Already Believe · NLT

The gap

We often **know** the right thing — and still react from old habits. **Justification** may be settled; **sanctification** still needs training (1 Timothy 4:7).

The Five Steps

Step	What you do	One-line cue
1. Notice	Pause. Name what is rising. It is not the whole of who you are in Christ.	"Something is rising — I see it."
2. Discern	Galatians 5 — sinful nature or fruit of the Spirit?	"This is my sinful nature, not who I am becoming in Christ."
3. Declare	Speak a specific Scripture into the moment.	Anger: Eph 4:26 · Anxiety / phone: Phil 4:6 · Bitterness: Eph 4:31–32
4. Return	Brief prayer — turn to God now.	"Lord, rule here. Help me love them."
5. Act	Obey the word now — don't wait for the feeling to leave.	Do the next faithful thing.

Galatians 5 quick check

Sinful nature includes: hostility, quarreling, jealousy, outbursts of anger, envy...

Fruit of the Spirit: love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control.

Goal: fruit of the Spirit in real relationships — **not** emotional emptiness.

Live practice (60 seconds)

Think of one trigger you face often (especially at home). Silently run the five steps once right now.

One-week challenge

1. Pick **one** recurring trigger.
2. Practice the **five steps** every time it appears.
3. **Report** to a friend, spouse, or small group.

“Don’t just listen to God’s word. You must do what it says.” — James 1:22 (NLT)

Grace is not opposed to effort. Grace is opposed to earning.

We train because we have been justified – not in order to be justified.

Justified once. Sanctified daily.